

TOPIC 5: RULES OF GHUNNAH (NASAL SOUND)

1. Meaning of Ghunnah

Ghunnah is a nasal sound produced when pronouncing the letters Noon (ن) and Meem (م) under certain conditions. The sound comes from the nose and is held for approximately two counts in full Ghunnah.

2. Where Ghunnah Applies

- Noon and Meem with Shaddah (ّّ / ّّّ) – full Ghunnah.
- Idgham with Ghunnah (Noon Sakinah/Tanwin before ن ن ن ن).
- Ikhfa (Noon Sakinah/Tanwin before the 15 Ikhfa letters) – nasal sound while concealing.
- Iqlab (Noon Sakinah/Tanwin before م) – Meem sound with Ghunnah.
- Ikhfa Shafawi and Idgham Shafawi for Meem Sakinah.

3. Practical Application

Listen to a qualified reciter; practise holding the nasal sound evenly for two counts where required; avoid over- or under-emphasising. Group exercises and correction by a teacher improve accuracy.

4. Summary

Ghunnah is the nasal quality of Noon and Meem in specified rules. Correct application is essential for beautiful and accurate Qur'anic recitation.

End of Topic 5